

Sample Homeowners Insurance Policy - ClaimWise Demo

Section 1: Definitions

"Dwelling" means the residential structure identified on the Declarations Page, including attached structures.

"Personal Property" means household and personal belongings owned by the policyholder or resident family members, located within the Dwelling.

"Water Damage" means damage caused by the sudden and accidental discharge or overflow of water from a plumbing, heating, air conditioning, or household appliance system located within the Dwelling.

Section 2: Covered Perils

This policy covers direct physical loss to the Dwelling and Personal Property caused by: fire or lightning; windstorm or hail; explosion; theft; vandalism or malicious mischief; falling objects; weight of ice, snow, or sleet; sudden and accidental discharge or overflow of water from plumbing, heating, or household appliances; and freezing of plumbing systems, provided reasonable care was taken to maintain heat in the Dwelling.

Section 3: Exclusions

This policy does NOT cover loss caused by: (a) flood, surface water, waves, tidal water, or overflow of a body of water, regardless of cause; (b) earth movement, including earthquake, landslide, or sinkhole; (c) sewer or drain backup, unless a Water Backup Endorsement is attached; (d) neglect or failure to protect property from further damage after a loss occurs; (e) mold, fungus, or wet rot damage that results from a failure to promptly report and remediate a covered water loss; (f) gradual, ongoing seepage or leakage occurring over a period of weeks, months, or years; (g) war or nuclear hazard.

3.1 Flood Exclusion: Damage caused by flooding, including overflow of rivers, streams, or other bodies of water, and damage from heavy rainfall causing surface water intrusion, is excluded under this policy. Flood coverage may be available under a separate flood insurance policy, such as through the National Flood Insurance Program (NFIP).

3.2 Delayed Discovery / Mold Exclusion: If water damage is not discovered and reported within a reasonable time (generally within 7 days of the event or the policyholder's return to the property), resulting mold remediation costs may be excluded or limited.

3.3 Sewer and Drain Backup Exclusion: Loss caused by water or waterborne material which backs up through sewers or drains, or which overflows from a sump pump, is excluded unless a Water Backup Endorsement is shown on the Declarations Page.

Section 4: Theft and High-Value Items

Coverage for theft of jewelry, watches, and furs is limited to \$2,500 per occurrence unless the items are separately scheduled on a Personal Property Endorsement with proof of value (appraisal or receipt). Claims involving high-value items without proof of ownership or without a filed police report may require additional investigation before any payment is authorized.

Section 5: Required Documentation for Claims

To process a claim, the policyholder must submit: (1) a completed claim form; (2) photographs or video of the damage; (3) a police report for theft, vandalism, or break-in claims; (4) a detailed inventory of damaged or stolen Personal Property with estimated values; and (5) contractor repair estimates for structural damage.

Section 6: Claims Process

Upon receiving a completed claim submission, a licensed claims adjuster will review the documentation, may schedule a property inspection, and will issue a coverage determination within 15 business days of receiving all required documentation. This policy document alone does not constitute a final coverage decision; all claims are subject to human adjuster review before payment is authorized.

Section 7: Deductibles

The standard all-perils deductible is shown on the Declarations Page. A separate, higher deductible may apply to windstorm or hail claims in certain geographic regions, as indicated on the Declarations Page.